Company Guidelines

Maintain Neutral or Positive Language

Reason: Users should not be made to feel shame surrounding their digital habits. It's counterintuitive to improving their mental health and not effective long term.
Example: Say apps are "allowed" at certain times instead of "blocked" at certain times

Maintain trust in users unless they request otherwise

Reason: We're trying to create a positive environment and ux.
Example: Assume tasks are completed when users affirm they are.

Problematic digital habits are never a reward

Reason: We don't want to further incentivize problematic phone usage and consent that mindless scrolling benefits the user in the short or long term
Example: "Coins", Do y for an extra 15 minutes of an app, etcetera are against the company's ethos. It is ok to suggest a task to complete before an app can be opened, but the language should make it clear that we are routine building.

Have a redirection available

Reason: If you save the user 5 minutes, and they spend it staring off into space or thinking about their ex, you've wasted 5 of their minutes. **WellPhone is additive, not subtractive.**
Example:

> *Non-Digital***:** Breathing exercises, Meditation, Light exercise, Crafting, Dexterity work
> *Digital:* Interesting article, Book/Audiobook apps, Journaling, Mood Check-in,

Don't waste the user's time

Reason: figure it out
Example: Never have the user wait x seconds before they can open an app unless there's a positive redirection in that 5 seconds.

Requested extra time on apps should always be segmentable

Reason: If an extra 15 minutes on an app has to be the next 15 minutes, it incentivizes the user to stay on the app for the duration of that time and request another 15 minutes later in the day.
Example: A user has exceeded their self-allotted time on the app for any number of reasons, but they still feel like there's more to explore. They only want to spend 15 more minutes, so they use 5 minutes then, 2 minutes later, and 4 minutes to end their use of the app for the day.

Use Cases

Riley *“My phone is interfering with something I value.”*

Bill *“My phone is helping me avoid something difficult.”*

Jill *“My phone is consuming the time I wanted to use for myself.”*

Val/Bob/Tina “*The useful thing I came to my phone for is attached to something that keeps distracting me.”*

Michael *“My entire life is on my phone and I don’t know how to change it”*

Riley is a 19-year-old college sophomore who loves to play hockey, but she was kicked off her club team for **falling behind in her academics**. Not being able to play hockey freed up her time, but she didn’t see any academic improvement. Her grades got worse. She was **chronically late to class** because she couldn’t get out of bed scrolling through her former teammates’ pages.

Riley needed a change and found WellPhone. She completed the onboarding and decided **strict interventions** were best for her. Because getting out of bed was her biggest morning obstacle, she added a morning intervention encouraging her to take a picture of her shower handle[1] within five minutes of her first phone pickup. When successful, it will **notify her friends that she is off to a good start**. Additionally, she opened each social media app on her phone 14 times a day on average. She chose to allow viewing social media on her 8th opening attempt as long as there are 20 minutes in between attempts. On attempts 1-7, she’s **redirected to class assignments and readings, simple hockey drills she added that can be completed anywhere, or calling/messaging a teammate** to remember they’re all rooting for her return.

[1] This photo will not be stored by wellphone, but it will be processed via image recognition

Bill was diagnosed with ADHD later in life when the coping mechanisms he unwittingly formed as a child stopped working. He started medication, but he still constantly forgets to take his medication and schedule appointments for refills. He likes to keep up with his friends and politics on twitter, but there's always a **one more tweet voice in his head**, especially if he has a daunting (sometimes it's deceptively easy) task ahead of him. Bill knows he's supposed to eat and drink more water on these meds, but sometimes 4 o'clock rolls around, and **he hasn't eaten anything** but a light snack.

Bill chose to allow the apps on his phone only after he's affirmed that he's **taken his medication**, completed a **sleep log**, and **set 3 goals** for the day. At periodic intervals throughout the day, he must affirm that he **drank a glass of water** to allow apps again. When he completed the onboarding, he **tagged** all the **account he follows** on twitter as friend, family, career, politics, or humor. Now, he can choose a feed with just his friends & family or he can go on a little humor scroll. He allowed himself 8 minutes at a time and opted in to the countdown timer so he knows when to read one last tweet.

Jill has **no free time** during the day. At night, she spends 2-3 hours on her phone doing things she can barely remember the next day. She only goes to sleep when she's too tired to keep her eyes open, phone in hand at max volume not charging, breaking her promise to do her skincare routine.

Jill set a **guided bedtime routine** that includes all her nightly steps. The routine turns her apps off an hour before her desired bedtime, so she can **read the book** she bought ages ago to ambient sleep-promoting noise. She turned on redirections without expecting anything, but she gained an extra few minutes a day to restart practicing Spanish which will make her eligible for bonuses at her job after enough time.

Val, Bob, and Tina became friends in freshman year, and now they're seniors. Their **primary form of communication is Instagram**. All 3 of them open instagram to text each other and get **sidetracked into spending 30+ minutes on the app**.

They downloaded wellphone together to message each other through instagram without the visual cues leading them to endless content. They enrolled in the social component of WellPhone too. Val and Bob found they wake up around the same time and talk to each other during their morning routines.

Michael is a 21-year-old community college student whose only personal device is his smartphone. He **uses it for everything**: streaming music, completing assignments, applying for jobs, banking, checking his email, navigating public transportation, and keeping up with his friends. The problem is that the same device he needs for school and work is also where he goes to watch videos, scroll social media, and shop when he gets bored. When he sits down to write an assignment, he opens his browser to find a source and ends up with a **youtube queue 10 videos long**. He plays music to focus, but it makes him **switch attention** to physical activities.

Michael found WellPhone because he wanted to use his phone better. During onboarding, he identified schoolwork and job applications as priorities and chose to make entertainment apps available only during specific windows. He also set up study mode where he can only access his learning management system, academic sources, textbooks, a text editor, a spreadsheet application, and a white noise system. After his designated study mode time is complete, he is redirected towards job application sites and whatever system he uses to manage his resume and cover letter until he **applies to 4 new jobs.** Additionally, when he repeatedly switches from his assignment to entertainment apps, WellPhone redirects him back to his assignment or to a short break away from the screen to refocus.

Onboarding. All questions are skippable

Created → Theodore Profit Last update → Sep 11, 2026

Name:

Age:

What is one big picture goal for you? I want to:

- ☐ Write a novel
- ☐ Learn a new language
- ☐ Read more
- ☐ Get a job
- ☐ Sleep 8 hours consistently
- ☐ Get jacked
- ☐ Have a clean or well-designed living space
- ☐ Improve my GPA
- ☐ Succeed in a certain class
- ☐ Learn a new creative skill. Specify

What do you want WellPhone to help you with?

- ☐ Build better routines
- ☐ Sleep better
- ☐ Form Habits
- ☐ Spend more time offline
- ☐ Be more intentional with my online use
- ☐ Achieve a goal I've put on the back burner
- ☐ Be more present with other people

What do you use your phone for?

- ☐ Communication
- ☐ Music
- ☐ School
- ☐ Work

- ☐ Job hunting
- ☐ Banking/finances
- ☐ Transportation/navigation
- ☐ Shopping
- ☐ Entertainment
- ☐ Social media
- ☐ News/current events
- ☐ Reading
- ☐ Exercise/health
- ☐ Organization
- ☐ Creative work
- ☐ Other

When do you use your phone the most?

- ☐ Morning
- ☐ Midday
- ☐ Evening
- ☐ Mealtimes
- ☐ My Commute
- ☐ Social Outings
- ☐ Toilet
- ☐ School
- ☐ Work
- ☐ Splitting focus during routine tasks like laundry, grocery shopping,
- ☐ Idle time (waiting in line, waiting for appointments/meetings,)

What other tech devices do you have, if any?

- ☐ Laptop
- ☐ Desktop
- ☐ Tablet
- ☐ Wearables (smart watch, glasses, ring, etc)
- ☐ Television

- ☐ E-Reader (nook, kindle with limited functionality)
- ☐ Digital Writing Pad

Where do you spend most of your digital time?

- ☐ Phone
- ☐ Laptop/Desktop
- ☐ Television

Why do you pick up your phone?

- ☐ Entertainment
- ☐ Something stimulating
- ☐ A break
- ☐ Social Connection
- ☐ News/information
- ☐ Shopping
- ☐ School/Career
- ☐ Something to avoid
- ☐ Reassurance/checking
- ☐ Habit—I don't really know
- ☐ Turn brain off

What usually happens after you pick it up?

- ☐ I do what I intended to do
- ☐ I do what I intended, then keep scrolling
- ☐ I get distracted almost immediately
- ☐ I switch between several apps
- ☐ I lose track of time
- ☐ I don't really know

What do you struggle with in the morning?

- ☐ Getting out of bed
- ☐ Waking up feeling refreshed
- ☐ Completing all tasks in my morning routine
- ☐ Forgetting essential tasks (medication, hygiene, grooming)

- ☐ Leaving my house on time
- ☐ Distractions
- ☐ Overthinking
- ☐ Overwhelm
- ☐ Anxiety
- ☐ Hopelessness

What do you struggle with in the evening?

- ☐ Consistent Bedtime
- ☐ Revenge Bedtime Procrastination[1]
- ☐ Reducing Blue Light to increase sleep quality
- ☐ Forgetting essential tasks (medication, hygiene, grooming)
- ☐ Completing all tasks every night
- ☐ Distractions
- ☐ Overthinking
- ☐ Overwhelm
- ☐ Anxiety
- ☐ Hopelessness

What do you struggle with at mealtimes?

- ☐ Deciding what to eat
- ☐ Making something to eat
- ☐ Poor appetite
- ☐ Eating without distractions
- ☐ Eating 3x a day or as many times as you want
- ☐ Overthinking
- ☐ Overwhelm
- ☐ Anxiety

What else do you struggle with?

- ☐ Meeting Deadlines
- ☐ Procrastinating on projects without deadlines
- ☐ Time Management

- ☐ Emotional Regulation
- ☐ Working Memory
- ☐ Impulsivity
- ☐ Overspending (on my phone)
- ☐ Mindfulness
- ☐ Administrative tasks (paying bills, making phone calls)
- ☐ Cleaning and other household tasks
- ☐ Other chores

What are your goals?

- ☐ Reducing screentime
- ☐ Making screentime more meaningful
- ☐ Creating a routine
- ☐ Increasing productivity
- ☐ Remembering tasks or appointments
- ☐ Improving mental health
- ☐ Unsure

What behaviors do you want to decrease? *Adaptive*

- ☐ Doomscrolling
- ☐ Revenge Bedtime Procrastination
- ☐ Using my phone as an avoidance tactic
- ☐ Impulsive buying
- ☐ Checking messages constantly
- ☐ Watching short-form videos
- ☐ Losing track of time
- ☐ Comparing myself to people online
- ☐ Using my phone during meals
- ☐ Using my phone around friends/family
- ☐ Picking up my phone when I'm bored
- ☐ Constantly checking news
- ☐ Other

Which ONE causes you the most trouble?

What's one nutritional habit you want to form/increase? *Adaptive*

- ☐ Drink water
- ☐ Take daily supplements
- ☐ Eat 3 meals a day
- ☐ Eat breakfast

What's one dental habit you want to form/increase? *Adaptive*

- ☐ Brushing teeth
- ☐ Brushing/scraping tongue
- ☐ Flossing
- ☐ Mouthwash
- ☐ Post eating rinse

What's one hygienic habit you want to form? *Adaptive*

- ☐ Skincare
- ☐ Bathing habit change
- ☐ Laundry change
- ☐ Washing hands
- ☐ Clean bedsheets

What's one grooming habit you want to form? *Adaptive*

- ☐ Hair Styling
- ☐ Moisturizing
- ☐ Nail Care
- ☐ Hair removal
- ☐ Beard/Mustache Care
- ☐ Folding clothes

What's one physical habit you want to form? *Adaptive*

- ☐ Daily cardio
- ☐ Daily calisthenics
- ☐ Daily balance work
- ☐ Daily stretching

- ☐ Posture correction
- ☐ Eye distance

How much intervention do you want?

- ☐ Gentle
- ☐ Structured
- ☐ Strict

Would you like other people to be part of your WellPhone experience?

- ☐ Pre-selected friend(s)
- ☐ Parent(s)
- ☐ Sibling(s)
- ☐ Family
- ☐ Acquaintance(s)
- ☐ Roommate(s)
- ☐ Teammate(s)
- ☐ Significant Other(s)
- ☐ Everyone I know (requires contact permission)
- ☐ Curated member(s) of the WellPhone network previously unknown to you (We will keep all personally identifying information private and secure. We will only share a chosen nickname with your consent)

What would you want other people to do?

- ☐ Encourage me
- ☐ Congratulate me
- ☐ Do my routines with me
- ☐ Know when I complete my goals
- ☐ Help me stay accountable
- ☐ Something else

Micro brain tasks you want

- ☐ Vocabulary words in English
- ☐ Vocabulary words in another language I'm fluent in
- ☐ Vocabulary words in a language I'm learning

- ☐ Fun fact
- ☐ Quotes
- ☐ Bible verses
- ☐ Quran Verses
- ☐ Torah verses
- ☐ Mental arithmetic
- ☐ Hand dexterity drills
- ☐ Enter your own tasks that can be completed in under a minute

Macro brain tasks you want

- ☐ Reading a book or short story
- ☐ Reading a historical document
- ☐ Reading news article
- ☐ Reading an informative article
- ☐ Visualization exercise
- ☐ Crossword and other word puzzle
- ☐ Sudoku and other number puzzles
- ☐ Complex math problems
- ☐ New skill. Specify

What new skill do you want to learn on your phone, if any?

- ☐ Fiction writing
- ☐ Poetry writing
- ☐ Music mixing
- ☐ Video editing
- ☐ Photo editing
- ☐ Coding
- ☐ Other

When you use social media, what do you actually want to see?

- ☐ Friends/family
- ☐ Humor
- ☐ News

- ☐ Politics
- ☐ Sports
- ☐ Career/professional content
- ☐ Hobbies/interests
- ☐ Shopping
- ☐ Beauty/fashion
- ☐ Fitness
- ☐ Educational content
- ☐ Inspiration
- ☐ Other

Are there types of content you intentionally want to see less often (No guarantees)?

- ☐ Ragebait
- ☐ Self-Harm
- ☐ Suicide
- ☐ Risk-Taking and Stunts
- ☐ Body
- ☐ Beauty
- ☐ Food
- ☐ Fitness
- ☐ Alcohol
- ☐ Smoking
- ☐ Nicotine/Tobacco
- ☐ Marijuana
- ☐ Money/Spending
- ☐ Relationship
- ☐ News/Current Events
- ☐ Bullying
- ☐ Sexual Assault
    - ☐ Personal Stories

- ☐ Promotions of Rape Culture
- ☐ Other

Do you want to limit or eliminate problem apps?

- ☐ Yes - limit
- ☐ Yes - eliminate
- ☐ No

Do you trust yourself to be honest with us and yourself? *Adaptive*

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

Tag apps on phone as essential, mostly useful, entertainment, social connection, distracting but occasionally useful, unnecessary.

Suggested Tasks for User

1. Rearranging home screen (can't be done via our app on IPhone; possible on android)
    1.1. Add our app's half screen widget.
    1.2. Select up to 12 essential apps
        1.2.1. Phone
        1.2.2. Camera
        1.2.3. Messaging Apps that can't be integrated to WellPhone
        1.2.4. Clock
        1.2.5. Web Browser
        1.2.6. Navigation
        1.2.7. Wallet
        1.2.8. Banking
        1.2.9. Notes
        1.2.10. Music
        1.2.11. Email
        1.2.12. Calendar
        1.2.13. Car

        1.2.14. Home
        1.2.15. Books
        1.2.16. Other
    1.3. Select up to 6 widgets for page 2.
        1.3.1. Weather
        1.3.2. Calculator
        1.3.3. FindMy/Life360
        1.3.4. Contacts
        1.3.5. Calendar
        1.3.6. Mail
        1.3.7. Banking
        1.3.8. Batteries
        1.3.9. Other
2. Guided Social Media Following Detox (check feature page)
3. Set persistent notifications in settings

Permissions Needed from user

- Camera (optional for increased accountability
- Contacts for social component
- Screentime
- Notifications

WELLPhone

A healthier relationship with your phone.

1. Executive Summary

WellPhone is a digital-wellbeing, lifestyle, and productivity platform designed to help people regain control of how they use their smartphones without asking them to give up the useful parts of having one.

The problem is not that smartphones are inherently bad. The problem is that modern smartphones make it extremely easy for useful tools and attention-consuming platforms to coexist on the same device, often governed by competing incentives. People can spend hours checking, scrolling, switching between apps, and seeking stimulation when they intended to work, sleep, exercise, socialize, or simply rest.

Existing solutions generally take one of two approaches: they either rely on willpower and simple screen-time statistics or aggressively block distracting applications. WellPhone takes a more holistic approach. It combines personalized behavioral interventions, intentional friction, accountability, routines, and positive redirection so that reducing problematic phone use is not the end goal—it is a means of getting more life back.

The product is built around a simple principle:

The goal is not to use your phone as little as possible. The goal is to use your phone in ways that make your life better.

WellPhone will initially target young adults, students, and early-career adults who recognize that their phone use interferes with sleep, productivity, relationships, routines, hobbies, or personal goals but who do not want a "digital detox" or a radically stripped-down device.

The company will use a freemium consumer subscription model, with paid features centered on personalization, advanced routines, accountability, and behavioral insights.

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2. The Problem

Problem Statement

Problematic smartphone use is increasingly recognized as a behavioral issue rather than simply a question of how many hours someone spends looking at a screen.

Research has associated problematic smartphone use with outcomes including poor sleep, anxiety, depression, stress, impaired attention, and other difficulties. A 2024 meta-analysis covering 106 articles and nearly 98,000 participants estimated global problematic-smartphone-use prevalence at 37.1%, while emphasizing substantial variation between populations and measurement methods.[2]

A newer systematic review and meta-analysis focused specifically on young adults found a moderate association between problematic smartphone use and poor sleep quality, including delayed sleep onset, shorter sleep duration, poorer overall sleep quality, and greater daytime dysfunction.

The problem manifests in everyday life:

- doomscrolling
- compulsive checking
- revenge bedtime procrastination
- using the phone to avoid uncomfortable tasks or interactions
- fragmented attention
- difficulty maintaining routines
- procrastination
- missed deadlines and commitments
- difficulty relaxing without stimulation
- using the phone during meals, social situations, work, and school
- impulsive online consumption
- replacing movement, hobbies, or social interaction with passive screen use

The result is not merely "too much screen time."

It is **time and attention displaced from the things users actually value.**

Why Existing Solutions Fall Short

Most digital-wellbeing products focus on one of three mechanisms:

1. **Measurement:** show users how much time they spend on their phones.
2. **Restriction:** block apps, websites, or categories.
3. **Friction:** make distracting apps slightly harder to access.

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[2] Lu, X., An, X., & Chen, S. (2024). Trends and Influencing Factors in Problematic Smartphone Use Prevalence (2012-2022): A Systematic Review and Meta-Analysis. *Cyberpsychology, behavior and social networking*, *27*(9), 616–634. https://doi.org/10.1089/cyber.2023.0548

These mechanisms can work, but they often leave a major question unanswered:

What should the user do instead?

WellPhone treats the transition away from a problematic behavior as a product problem of its own.

If a user successfully avoids 20 minutes of scrolling and then sits on the couch staring at the ceiling, the intervention has technically succeeded but practically failed.

WellPhone therefore considers **redirection a core product feature, not an afterthought.**

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3. The WellPhone Philosophy

The company's internal guidelines should become part of the brand.

Principle 1: We are pro-human, not anti-phone.

A smartphone can be a camera, map, library, calendar, bank, communication device, notebook, music player, accessibility tool, and gateway to the world.

WellPhone should never imply that using a phone is inherently bad.

Principle 2: No shame.

Users should never feel like they have failed because they used an app.

The language should be behavioral and neutral:

"Instagram is available again at 7:00 PM."

rather than:

"You failed your screen-time limit."

This philosophy is already present in the company's guidelines.

Principle 3: Never reward the behavior we're trying to reduce.

WellPhone should not create an ironic secondary addiction loop through coins, streaks, prizes, or additional access to distracting apps.

The product should not say:

> "Congratulations! You exercised, so now you earned 30 minutes of TikTok."

That would contradict the company's purpose.

Principle 4: Saved time should become something.

When WellPhone interrupts a behavior, it should offer a meaningful next action.

Non-comprehensive Examples include:

- stretching
- walking
- breathing exercises
- journaling
- reading
- listening to an audiobook
- completing a small household task
- drinking water
- preparing food
- practicing an instrument
- contacting a friend
- starting a work task
- language learning
- viewing art
- reading a news article
- reading an important historical/current document/transcription
- reading a random informative article
- learning and using a new vocabulary term
- bible/quran/torah verse ONLY AFTER AGREEMENT TO THIS INTERVENTION
- learning a phone skill
    - mixing music or other audio engineering
    - graphic design
    - video editing
- building a financial plan
- simply leaving the phone behind

The company guidelines explicitly establish this redirection principle.

Principle 5: Trust the user.

WellPhone is not a digital prison.

Whenever technically possible, users remain in control. The product uses friction and structure to make better decisions easier rather than attempting to overpower the user.

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4. The Product

Core Product

WellPhone is a personalized behavioral system that adapts to **when, why, and how a person uses their phone.**

The experience begins with a substantially more detailed onboarding process than traditional screen-time apps.

The user identifies:

- when they use their phone most
- morning and evening difficulties
- mealtime habits
- work and school struggles
- procrastination patterns
- routines they want to build
- behaviors they want to reduce
- physical, nutritional, dental, grooming, and household habits
- personal goals

These concepts are already represented extensively in the current onboarding prototype.

Instead of asking only:

"How much screen time do you want?"

WellPhone asks:

"What is your phone getting in the way of?"

That distinction should become central to the product.

Key Launch Features

Onboarding

Guided Morning/Evening Routines
Peer Connection
Curated Social Media Feeds
Redirection
Emotional Check-Ins
Data collection/visualization
Wellness Reminders

Features for Scaling

Shopping Interventions and Financial Wellness
Meal Planning
Integration with wearables
Increased personalization

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5. The Core WellPhone Loop

1. Understand

WellPhone learns the user's patterns, goals, routines, and high-risk moments.

2. Intervene

When a user reaches a problematic moment, WellPhone introduces an appropriate amount of friction.

Interventions might include:

- a pause
- breathing
- a brief reflection
- an intentionality prompt
- delayed access
- a routine reminder
- accountability
- app-specific limits
- scheduled availability

3. Redirect

Instead of simply saying "no," WellPhone offers an immediately available alternative.

4. Support

Users can optionally involve an accountability partner for commitments, check-ins, or encouragement.

5. Learn

The system observes which interventions actually help the individual and becomes increasingly personalized.

This is the company's most important product distinction:

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6. MVP

The initial version should be dramatically narrower than the eventual vision.

MVP features

Personalized onboarding

- usage patterns
- goals
- routines
- problematic behaviors
- preferred interventions

App and website intervention

- scheduled limits
- intentional delays
- contextual friction
- focus periods

Morning and evening routines

- guided wake-up
- bedtime routine
- reminders for selected tasks
- reduced-distraction periods

Saved-time redirection

- personalized recommendations
- quick physical activities
- reading/journaling
- household/productivity actions
- user-selected activities

Basic accountability

- invite trusted person(s)
- check-in commitments
- confirmation and encouragement
- no remote control of another adult's device

Usage insights

- time recovered
- intervention frequency
- successful redirections
- patterns by time of day
- apps in context
- progress toward user-defined goals

The current outline also proposes persistent notifications, essential-app home-screen organization, social features, and extensive task categories.

Those ideas are valuable, but many belong after the core behavioral loop has proven itself.

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7. What Should Be Avoided

This is important.

Do not initially build:

A full social network.

Social accountability is useful. Becoming another social-media platform is not.

Social-feed curation as a major product pillar.

A giant habit tracker.

WellPhone should use habits to improve phone behavior and external lifestyle, not become another app users have to maintain.

A "gamified" reward economy.

Wellness streaks are ok, but they should not be central to the ux.

A mental-health treatment platform.

WellPhone can support wellbeing, sleep, routines, mindfulness, and healthier technology use. It should not claim to diagnose or treat depression, anxiety, eating disorders, ADHD, or other clinical conditions.

There is promising evidence for digital interventions, but the evidence is heterogeneous and long-term engagement remains a challenge.

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8. Competitive Landscape

Opal

Opal is the clearest large software competitor claiming 10M users with 7M student users. Its U.S. App Store listing currently shows a 4.7 rating from approximately 88,000 ratings and paid plans including a $99.99 annual plan. Opal is slightly gamified and emphasizes app limits, blocking, focus sessions, usage data, and other productivity mechanisms.

Strength: enormous brand awareness and mature product.

Weakness/opportunity: WellPhone can differentiate around personalization, life routines, accountability, and what happens after distraction is interrupted rather than competing solely on blocking.

ScreenZen

ScreenZen positions itself as a free, donation-supported screen-time product and says more than one million people use it across iOS, macOS, Windows, and Android. It focuses on blocking, scheduling, and mindful app access.

Strength: accessibility and strong mission alignment.

Weakness/opportunity: WellPhone can offer a deeper personalized behavioral layer rather than competing primarily as a free blocking utility.

Unpluq

Unpluq is a combination of hardware and software that emphasizes reducing distractions without deleting apps and currently reports more than 250,000 users. Its family product is priced at $79.95/year for up to three phones and $99.95/year for unlimited phones.

Strength: strong brand positioning around reducing friction and changing behavior without deleting apps.

Weakness/opportunity: WellPhone can differentiate through individualized routines, accountability, redirection, and broader wellbeing/productivity support.

one sec

one sec focuses on intentional friction before entering distracting apps. Its current documentation says the free version targets one app, while Pro unlocks unlimited apps and additional intervention types; the company reports more than 80,000 five-star App Store ratings and cites research showing an average 57% reduction in usage.

Strength: elegant behavioral intervention and strong evidence-oriented positioning.

Weakness/opportunity: WellPhone can move beyond the moment of app opening into the broader context of the user's day.

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9. Competitive Positioning

The company should not position itself as:

"A better app blocker."

Instead:

Existing category

"Use your phone less."

WellPhone

"Use your phone better—and use the time you get back for your life."

The competitive moat should eventually come from the combination of:

Personalization + behavioral intervention + redirection + accountability + routines + trust

rather than any single feature.

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10. Technology Strategy

The product needs to be designed around platform realities from day one.

Apple provides the Screen Time APIs through Family Controls, Managed Settings, and Device Activity, enabling apps to monitor usage and apply restrictions with user authorization. Apple requires specific entitlements for access to these capabilities.

There are also important limitations. Apple's Screen Time API does not provide unrestricted control of the entire device; the company's developer guidance and forums document limitations around completely locking the device.

This means WellPhone's product architecture should treat the operating system as a partner and constraint, not something the company can simply work around.

Technical priorities

Phase 1

- iOS
- privacy-preserving usage access
- app/domain intervention
- notifications
- routines

Phase 2

- Android parity
- expanded integrations
- home-screen experience
- richer accountability

Phase 3

- desktop/browser integrations
- wearables
- optional hardware
- family/household products

Privacy must be a foundational differentiator.

Apple's current developer terms place significant limits on how device/usage data obtained through Family Controls can be used and prohibit using it for advertising, ad measurement, or data brokerage.

WellPhone should therefore adopt a simple rule:

User behavioral data exists to serve the user—not advertisers.

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11. Target Customer

Primary Customer

Young adults approximately 16–34 who:

- own smartphones
- recognize that their phone use is excessive or unintentional
- are ambitious or goal-oriented
- struggle with routines, attention, sleep, procrastination, or consistency
- have already tried Screen Time or app blockers
- do not want to become "phone-free"
- want their device to support their ambitions rather than compete with them

Initial market

College students and young professionals.

This market is attractive because their phone can interfere simultaneously with:

- academic performance
- sleep
- social relationships
- exercise
- finances
- household responsibilities
- career development
- hobbies
- personal projects

The product can then expand into:

- parents
- families
- ADHD-oriented productivity users
- creators
- entrepreneurs
- knowledge workers
- organizations and universities

Importantly, WellPhone should not market itself as exclusively an ADHD product or mental-health product unless future research and product development justify that specialization.

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12. Social Mission

WellPhone's social mission is broader than "less screen time."

The mission is:

Increase people's ability to direct their own attention, time, and energy toward the lives they want to live.

The company can advance this mission through:

- accessible, free functionality
- student pricing
- inclusive product research
- culturally diverse user testing
- partnerships with schools and community organizations
- privacy-first design
- research into digital wellbeing disparities

The existing application identifies racial equity and mental health as major social-benefit areas.

Those values should remain, but they should be translated into concrete practices rather than left as broad claims.

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13. Business Model

Freemium

Free

- basic usage insights
- one or two interventions
- limited routines
- basic redirection
- limited accountability

WellPhone Premium

Illustrative target pricing:

$2.99/week

$8.99/month

$59.99/year

A ~21 day trial will introduce premium functionality

Major acquisition moments with extended free trials include:

- back-to-school
- graduation
- new jobs
- "new routine" periods
- exam seasons
- New Year's resolutions
- summer productivity resets

Future revenue

Once consumer retention is proven:

- student/university partnerships
- employer wellness programs
- family plans
- premium accountability products
- hardware integrations
- research partnerships

The company should resist advertising as a monetization strategy.

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14. Go-To-Market Strategy

Stage 1: Founding Community

Begin with a small cohort of highly motivated users.

Ideal early adopters are not random people who downloaded a screen-time app once. They are people who have already tried to change their relationship with their phones.

Recruit through:

- college communities (UMD especially)
- productivity communities
- Reddit
- TikTok/Instagram creators discussing digital wellbeing
- student organizations
- wellness communities
- founder networks
- friends-of-friends

Get as much feedback and user data as possible to discover:

Which interventions genuinely change behavior?

Stage 2: Demonstrable Results

The most powerful marketing asset will be a measurable story.

For example:

> "WellPhone helped our beta users recover an average of X minutes per day, with Y% reporting that they used that time for activities they had previously struggled to make time for."

Those figures should only be published after actual measurement.

The company's eventual growth loop should be:

User recovers time → life improves → user tells someone → new user joins → new user experiences improvement.

Stage 3: Campus Growth

College campuses are particularly attractive because WellPhone's value proposition intersects with academics, sleep, social life, physical activity, and independence.

Campus ambassadors can create localized growth without requiring the company to spend heavily on traditional advertising.

Recruit ambassadors from HBCUs and Minority-Serving Institutions; R1 universities; and community colleges.

Target built-in communities like campus organizations, sports teams, and residential halls.

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15. Key Metrics

Product metrics

- activation rate
- percentage completing onboarding
    - Skipped onboarding questions
    - exit points
- percentage creating first routine
- percentage completing first intervention
- intervention success rate
- successful redirections
- average time recovered
- weekly active users
- retention at 7/30/90 days

Business metrics

- free-to-paid conversion
- trial-to-paid conversion
- monthly recurring revenue
- annual recurring revenue
- churn
- customer acquisition cost
- lifetime value
- payback period

Mission metrics

The most important metric should eventually be something like:

Meaningful Time Recovered

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16. Product Roadmap

Phase I — Prove the Intervention

Build:

- onboarding
- app intervention
- routines
- basic redirection
- basic analytics
- simple accountability

Goal:

Prove that personalized intervention changes behavior.

Phase II — Build the System

Add:

- adaptive interventions
- richer routines
- behavioral patterns
- deeper accountability
- personalized suggestions
- Android
- integrations

Goal:

Prove that users retain because WellPhone becomes part of their daily life.

Phase III — Build the Platform

Add:

- family plans
- institutional partnerships
- desktop integrations
- wearables
- optional hardware
- advanced AI personalization
- research partnerships

Goal:

Turn WellPhone from an app into an ecosystem for intentional technology use.

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17. Risks and How We Address Them

Risk: Users can simply uninstall the app.

Response:

WellPhone should create value.

Optional stronger protection can be offered, but the core product should make users want to keep it.

Risk: Apple and Google limit functionality.

Response:

Design around supported operating-system capabilities and maintain a platform-specific architecture.

Do not make the company's entire value proposition depend on one API.

Risk: The category becomes crowded.

Response:

Do not compete exclusively on blocking.

Build the behavioral layer:
intervention → redirection → routine → accountability → personalization.

Risk: Retention is poor.

This is a particularly serious risk. Research on smartphone mental-health apps suggests that feasibility and continued engagement can decline over time.

Response:

Make WellPhone useful even after the user's phone habits improve.

A successful customer should eventually need **less intervention**, not more.

That creates an important philosophical and business challenge:

How do you build a profitable product whose ideal outcome is that the customer needs it less?

The answer may ultimately be retention through expanding usefulness—not maintaining dependence.

Risk: WellPhone becomes another distracting app.

Response:

The product itself should be intentionally quiet.

Minimal notifications. Minimal feeds. Minimal unnecessary time in the app.

The best WellPhone session may be one the user barely notices.

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18. Brand

Brand personality

WellPhone should feel:

- intelligent
- warm
- nonjudgmental
- practical
- slightly playful
- optimistic

- human

It should never feel:

- preachy
- clinical
- punitive
- puritanical
- productivity-bro
- "digital detox" influencer

The company is not asking:

"Can you stop being addicted to your phone?"

It is asking:

"What would you do with your time if your phone stopped taking it?"

That is a much better brand question.

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19. Defensibility

The initial technology itself will not be highly defensible. App blocking can be replicated.

The long-term defensibility should come from:

Behavioral dataset

Anonymized understanding of which interventions work for which contexts and user profiles, subject to privacy and consent requirements.

Personalization

WellPhone becomes increasingly effective because it understands the individual rather than applying one-size-fits-all rules.

Trust

A privacy-first brand becomes particularly valuable in a category involving highly sensitive behavioral information.

Community

Accountability relationships create switching costs that generic blockers lack.

Brand

WellPhone can own a more positive category:

intentional technology use

rather than competing forever inside:

screen-time blocking.

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20. Founding Team

The founding team should emphasize lived experience with the problem as an asset, while avoiding the implication that personal experience alone establishes scientific expertise.

The team's next major capability gaps should be filled through advisors or hires in:

- behavioral science
- mobile engineering
- product design
- privacy/legal compliance
- growth
- research/measurement

This is particularly important because the company's differentiation depends on whether its interventions actually work—not merely whether they look good in an app store.

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21. Ownership and Governance

The current proposal is a 70/30 founder split, with the majority owned by the startup's originator to preserve dedication, fairness, and avoid deadlocks.

The company should formalize:

- vesting

- intellectual-property assignment
- decision rights
- founder responsibilities
- what happens if a founder leaves
- deadlock resolution
- future fundraising dilution

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22. Immediate Priorities

Before launching the full product, WellPhone should answer five questions through a small beta:

1. What problem causes users to install?

Is it sleep? Doomscrolling? Procrastination? Morning routines? Social media? General "I waste too much time"?

2. Which intervention actually works?

A beautiful feature is irrelevant if users simply dismiss it.

3. Does redirection work?

This is potentially one of WellPhone's most important differentiators.

4. Do accountability features increase retention?

Or do users simply find them annoying?

5. Will people pay? Is the price right?

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23. The Company in One Sentence

WellPhone helps people build a healthier relationship with their smartphones by reducing unintentional use, strengthening everyday routines, and turning recovered screen time into time for the rest of their lives.

24. The Company in One Paragraph

WellPhone is a digital-wellbeing platform that helps people use their smartphones intentionally instead of reflexively. Rather than treating phones as inherently harmful or relying solely on app blocking, WellPhone combines personalized behavioral interventions, intentional friction, routines, accountability, and positive redirection. The goal is not simply to reduce screen time, but to help users reclaim attention for sleep, work, school, relationships, exercise, hobbies, and the things they actually care about. WellPhone's philosophy is simple: **your phone should serve your life, not consume it.**

25. The Long-Term Vision

The long-term opportunity is bigger than an app blocker.

Smartphones have become the primary interface through which people communicate, work, learn, shop, navigate, consume entertainment, manage money, organize their lives, and increasingly interact with AI. WellPhone want to provide a platform that users can rely on for all aspects of wellness, including but not limited to social, financial, mental, physical, and occupational wellness

The answer cannot realistically be to remove smartphones from people's lives.

The answer is to make the relationship healthier.

WellPhone's ultimate vision is therefore not a world in which people use their phones less.

It is a world in which people use them **with purpose.**

Q&A

What does WellPhone actually do?

Wellphone stages personalized interventions to address unwanted excessive screentime, “bed rotting”, bedtime/routine creep, breaking habits, reduced attention spans, etcetera.

Ok, but how does it do that? What actually happens when I open, say, TikTok?

That is almost entirely up to you. WellPhone can redirect you to an online or offline non-TikTok task of your choosing depending on the time you have available. WellPhone can redirect you to our social media wrapper that only shows you specific topics or creators from any social media site that’s supported, e.g., see TikToks, tweets, reels, and reddit posts, just TikToks, or any combination of the three. Depending on what mode you chose, you can also continue on to TikTok and designate an end time with a live countdown/countup. Another option is to continue on to TikTok with a persistent banner telling you what you came for, like checking your friends post, checking dms, or finding a chicken recipe.

Why would someone choose WellPhone over the abundant current products on the market or Apple’s built-in tools?

Wellphone offers a more personalized experience than any product on the market. This comes from listening to our customers and people of all backgrounds who have unhealthy relationships with their phones.

Why can’t users just delete the apps?

They can try, but in my and my peers’ experience, it’s too easy to work around through navigating to that app’s website, using another device, or re-downloading.

How does WellPhone know when my phone use is problematic?

WellPhone gets to know the user through the onboarding process and after continued use. Switching between apps constantly, using apps outside of designated times, not giving your eyes a break, staying too long on a distracting app, or not completing what you set out to do can all be problematic. WellPhone will not leave you lost on the highway during a long road trip because you used google maps the whole time or unable to call an uber home because you stayed out later than usual. WellPhone will always endeavor to put you in control of your life, not the other way around.

Isn't this just another app I'll ignore?

You can try, but you'd also have to ignore and not use all the apps that distract you, so that's a win in my book.

Can't I just override it?

Yes, you're in control. If you want to see a change in your life, you probably shouldn't without an alternative in place. Hopefully, we'll get you to a space where you don't want to override it and actively enjoy our redirections.

Why would someone pay for this?

Time and self-actualization are priceless. I don't care how much you make an hour or if you're unemployed. Everyone's time is more valuable than 8.99/month. If it helps you save just 1 minute a day, and you can afford it, you can't afford not to have it.

What's next?

WellPhone hopes to be a comprehensive tool to help people use their time effectively for their wellbeing. Practically, this looks like expanding into planning people's groceries and meals, managing their calendars,

Is this a mental health app or medical technology?

No, WellPhone is not and never will be a substitute for professional medical and mental health providers. And no therapist, doctor, nurse, medical device, or coach will provide the service WellPhone does.

Will it actually work?

It worked for the founders, and hopefully it will be successful in beta testing. The only way to know if it works for you is starting your free trial.

Is there an expiration date? Will users stop needing the app to stage interventions?

It is likely that users will need WellPhone interventions less the longer they use it, but if WellPhone expands to our vision, there will be myriad other features that users can use for life after they get less dependent on distraction.